

Stands

Stands for speakers are a welcome feature, especially for the sub-woofer. The stands on the Altec Lansing FX-6021 were of solid metal and good build quality. The stand quality of the Logitech X-230 is good, too: it also has a swivel base for wall mounting.

DVD Audio

Whether it's vocals, treble or bass, the Altec Lansing MX-5021 is the best 2.1 set we've tested as far as DVD audio is concerned.

Audio CDs and MP3s

With audio CDs, the Altec Lansing MX-5021, with its very high dynamic range, doesn't distort the sound even at high volumes. Vocals at extreme ranges are handled comfortably by this set. To put it briefly, both the Altec Lansing sets reproduce audio CD sound very well indeed. MP3s, too, play very nicely on the Altec Lansing sets.

Bass And Treble

When it comes to deep bass—as in 50 Hz—the Altec Lansing MX-5021 is amongst the best we've tested. The FX-6021, though not just as good, also reproduces bass well. And when it comes to extreme treble, the Altec Lansing MX-5021 and the Logitech Z-2300 are the best performers.

1.2.2 Speaker Sets (5.1)

Here, we mention the four best sets in our comparison in the May 2006 issue, along with their strong points.

Philips MMS 5.500 i/C

- Clear sound with DVD audio, reasonably low distortion
- Good performance with audio CDs
- Reasonably good MP3 playback
- Inbuilt FM radio
- Looks good
- Costs just Rs 5,000!

